

NIKHITHA THOTAKURA

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SENIOR DEVSECOPS ENGINEER

Experienced DevOps Engineer with over 9 years of hands-on expertise in financial, media and technology sectors, specializing in AWS, Jenkins, Git, Linux, Ansible, Terraform, Kubernetes, Python, shell scripting, and Splunk. Skilled in automating infrastructure, streamlining CI/CD pipelines, and enhancing system reliability. Strong team collaborator with excellent communication skills, adept at translating technical challenges into effective, business-focused solutions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERTISE

DevOps & Automation | CI/CD Pipelines | Cloud Migration & Optimization | Infrastructure as Code | Kubernetes & Containers | GitOps & Deployments | Monitoring & Observability | Application Reliability | Security & Compliance | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Production Support & Incident Response

HANDS-ON SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms & Services:** AWS (EC2, ECS, EKS, S3, RDS, IAM, CloudFormation, Lambda, Secrets Manager, CloudWatch, VPC, API Gateway, Route 53, CloudFront)
- **Automation & Infrastructure Design:** Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Groovy, Python, Bash
- **Containers & Platform Engineering:** Kubernetes, ECS, EKS, Docker, Helm, Argo CD
- **Monitoring & Performance Insights:** Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, AppDynamics, Splunk, CloudWatch, SLO/SLI-based alerting and insights
- **Security and Governance:** IAM, Secrets Manager, SonarQube, VPC Security Controls
- **Versioning, Collaboration & DevOps Toolchain:** Git, GitLab, GitHub, Bitbucket, SVN, Jira, Confluence, Vault, Nexus, Artifactory

EXPERIENCE

Fox, Dallas, TX

September 2022 - Current

Sr DevOps Engineer

Support global infrastructure initiatives by building and maintaining CI/CD pipelines, improving observability, and ensuring platform reliability across cloud-native environments. Collaborate with cross-functional teams to drive automation, enhance developer productivity, and enable secure, scalable deployments for a wide range of microservices and applications.

- Supported **infrastructure provisioning** for multiple applications using Terraform and CloudFormation across AWS environments (EC2, EKS, VPC, IAM, S3, Route 53).
- Built and maintained **Jenkins pipelines** (with shared libraries) to enable automated build, test, and deployment workflows across dev, stage, and prod environments.

- Integrated **security scans** (Snyk, Clair, Trivy) into Jenkins CI pipelines to detect vulnerabilities early in the deployment lifecycle.
- Automated **EKS cluster setup** and configuration using Terraform, including creation of IAM roles, node groups, and Kubernetes namespaces.
- Developed reusable **Ansible playbooks** for consistent server provisioning and application environment setup on both Linux and Windows systems.
- Deployed and managed **containerized microservices** using Docker and Kubernetes (EKS), leveraging Helm for templated deployments.
- Implemented **GitOps practices** using **ArgoCD** for **EKS** workloads to achieve version-controlled, declarative deployments.
- Configured **monitoring** and **observability** stacks using Splunk, Datadog, and CloudWatch; built dashboards and alerts to monitor application health and pipeline performance.
- Built **automation scripts** for AWS resource cleanup, cost control, and tagging enforcement, contributing to reduced cloud spend.
- Integrated AWS Secrets Manager, IAM, and Vault into Jenkins pipelines for secure **secrets management**.
- Participated in infrastructure change validations and **production readiness checks** in line with internal compliance standards.
- Supported **incident response** and **on-call production support** for critical application pipelines; used runbooks and logs to triage and resolve issues.
- Automated patching and vulnerability remediation using **AWS Systems Manager** and Inspector, with notifications via Jenkins and Slack integrations.
- Created internal tooling using **Python** and Go to streamline **common DevOps tasks** and support cross-functional engineering teams.
- Participated in post-incident reviews, helped maintain runbooks, and supported chaos testing exercises to improve service resilience.
- Actively collaborated with developers and QA teams to **optimize build pipelines**, troubleshoot deployment issues, and **improve release velocity**.

Technologies Used: Jenkins, GitHub, Bitbucket, SVN, AWS (EC2, EKS, ECS, IAM, Lambda, S3, EBS, Route 53, CloudFront), Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes (EKS), Helm, Argo CD, Python, Bash, Go, Groovy, Splunk, Datadog, CloudWatch, Java

HSBC, Hyderabad, IN

May 2018 - December 2021

DevOps Engineer

Supported CI/CD automation, infrastructure provisioning, and production operations for web and mobile banking applications during large-scale modernization and AWS migration efforts.

- Contributed to the **migration** of on-premises applications to AWS, ensuring secure **infrastructure setup**, **minimal downtime**, and successful go-live of customer-facing services.
- Created **Terraform modules** and **Ansible playbooks** to provision infrastructure components like EC2, EKS, IAM, VPC, and S3 for dev/test/prod environments.

- Developed and maintained **Jenkins pipelines** (with shared libraries) to automate build, test, and deployment workflows across microservices.
- Worked on containerization of Java-based microservices using **Docker** and deployed them to **EKS**, improving scalability and release velocity.
- Integrated **monitoring and alerting** using Datadog, AppDynamics, Splunk, and CloudWatch; built dashboards and alerts for performance and availability tracking.
- Used **Ansible Tower** to orchestrate configuration management tasks and automate application deployments across cloud and on-prem environments.
- Supported **security compliance efforts** by integrating vulnerability scanning into pipelines and ensuring IAM and VPC-level controls were in place.
- Helped **streamline release processes** with health checks, smoke tests, and automated validations post-deployment.
- Automated **EC2/RDS backups, tagging enforcement**, and idle resource cleanup to optimize AWS usage and reduce costs.
- Supported CI/CD and infrastructure on-call; resolved incidents using runbooks and partnered with dev/QA teams to improve **pipeline reliability** and **environment consistency**.
- Conducted internal knowledge sharing on **infrastructure automation**, observability tools, and container deployment best practices.

Technologies Used: Jenkins, AWS (EC2, EKS, IAM, Lambda, S3, Route 53), Terraform, Ansible, Ansible Tower, Docker, Kubernetes, Argo CD, Vault, Git, SVN, Python, Groovy, Datadog, AppDynamics, Splunk, CloudWatch, Java

IBM, Hyderabad, IN

January 2015 - April 2018

System Administrator

- Managed and supported 45,000+ Unix/Linux servers across global data centers.
- Performed live upgrades and patching on Sun Solaris and Red Hat Linux systems.
- Administered disk and file systems using Veritas Volume Manager.
- Configured NFS, CIFS, and Samba shares; managed backups using tar and dump.
- Collaborated with hardware vendors for diagnostics, issue resolution, and root cause analysis.
- Maintained user and group access controls, implemented sudo policies, and enforced file system quotas for secure multi-user environments.
- Monitored system performance and health using Nagios and built-in Linux tools for proactive issue detection.
- Initiated automation of routine system tasks using shell scripting—sparking transition into DevOps.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science, JNTU, Hyderabad, India.

August 2010 - May 2014